

The Noble Lady Tārā's One Hundred and Eight Names

Ārya Tārā Bhaṭṭārikā Nāma Aṣṭaśatakam · Toh 727 · Derge Kangyur

རྒྱལ་མཁའ་མ་འཕགས་མ་སྒྲོ་མའི་མཆན་བར་རྒྱ་བར་དུ་པ།

Toh 727 in the Kangyur is a hymn known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Tārā Bhaṭṭārikā Nāma Aṣṭaśatakam and in Tibetan as the Rje btsun ma 'phags ma sgrol ma'i mtshan brgya rtsa brgyad, meaning "The Noble Lady Tārā's One Hundred and Eight Names." As its title indicates, it belongs to the genre of nāmastotra, or praise through enumeration of names, a form of devotional literature in which a deity's qualities and powers are celebrated through a sequence of epithets. The text is dedicated to Tārā, one of the most beloved bodhisattvas in the Mahāyāna and Vajrayāna traditions, revered as a swift protector and embodiment of compassionate activity. It was translated into Tibetan by the Indian master Dharmashrimitra and the Tibetan monk-translator Chökyi Zangpo, and it is preserved among the dhāraṇī and praise literature of the Kangyur.

This text was translated by the Indian master Dharmashrimitra and the Tibetan translator, the monk Chökyi Zangpo.

In the Indian language: Ārya Tārā Bhaṭṭārikā Nāma Aṣṭaśatakam. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Lady Tārā's One Hundred and Eight Names.

Homage to the noble lady Tārā.

The glorious, delightful grove of Tāla palms,
adorned with elements of every kind,
spread with trees of many various sorts,
where birds of many kinds give forth their calls,
where streams of many kinds resound with noise,
where deer of many kinds roam freely,
where flowers of every type and species
fill the air on all sides with their fragrance,
bearing fruit of every pleasant variety —
there the bees hum their melodious songs,
kiṇṇaras sing their sweet refrains,
the place is filled with maddened elephants,
the assembled hosts of accomplished wisdom-holders,
and gandharvas too join in the singing.

There the Sage who is free from attachment,
with other assemblies of bodhisattvas,
with the lords of the ten grounds,
with the noble Tārā and the other goddesses,
and with a thousand queens of wisdom-knowledge,
ever dwell in perfect attendance.

Surrounded by other hosts of wrathful kings
and by Hayagrīva and his retinue,
and striving to benefit all sentient beings,
the Blessed One Avalokiteśvara
resides there — and for that reason abides in glory.

At the lotus heart, the seat of the Sage,
endowed with great austerity,
possessed of loving-kindness and compassion,
he dwells in perfect propriety
to teach the Dharma to the great divine assembly.

Then rising from that seat in proper form,
mighty Vajrapāṇi,
endowed with supreme compassion,
made this request to Avalokiteśvara:

"Thieves, serpents, lions and fire,
elephants, tigers, and the terror of floods —
from all these the Sage, the Peaceful One,
has freed sentient beings who were sunk
in the ocean of cyclic existence,
bound by the snare of cyclic existence,
from the stain of attachment, aversion, and delusion.
Tell me who it is that has liberated sentient beings —
speak to me of this, O Great Sage."

The protector of the world then spoke these words:

"That glorious one is Avalokiteśvara.
Vajrapāṇi, the greatly perceptive one,
spoke these pleasing words: 'Listen, O sovereign lord of secrets.
Born from the power of the aspiration of the protector Amitābha,
I know her as mother of the world,
she who strives with great compassion

to draw forth all wandering beings.
Like the rising of the sun,
like the radiance of the full moon's face,
she illumines clearly all of these —
gods, humans, and demigods alike.
She causes the three worlds to tremble,
she strikes fear into yakṣas and rākṣasas,
bearing in her hand a blue utpala lotus,
crying out "Fear not! Fear not!"
She abides, soaring through the sky,
for the sake of protecting all wandering beings.
In times when the age of weapons has come,
and when the various terrors break out in turmoil,
the Victors have generated me
so that by the mere recollection of my names
I shall protect all sentient beings,
and from the ocean of manifold terrors
I shall deliver all sentient beings.
Therefore, in the world I have been proclaimed
by the host of Victors as Tārā, the Liberatrix.'

Having joined her palms together,
she sat in the presence of the assembly and spoke these words,
abiding in proper respect and reverence:
'Speak of that which the Victors proclaimed before —
speak the One Hundred and Eight Names.
The lords who are masters of the ten grounds,
the bodhisattvas who are supremely joyful,
dispel misdeeds and increase merit,
cause auspiciousness and renown to grow,
cause treasures and wealth to increase,
utterly destroy all diseases,
bestow upon the glorious one all blessings,
and cause life free from illness to flourish.
Having cultivated loving-kindness toward all sentient beings,
proclaim them, O Great Sage.'

Having made this request, the Blessed One,
the lord Avalokiteśvara, smiled broadly,
gazed in all directions,
and gave forth loving-kindness of this kind.

With his right hand he performed the gesture of blessing.
He who is endowed with the characteristics of merit
then spoke with great and supreme wisdom:

"Excellent! Excellent! O great ascetic!
You who cherish all sentient beings as one —
hear now, you people of great fortune.

Those people who proclaim this
will truly become lords of wealth,
will be completely freed from all illness,
will be perfectly endowed with all lordship,
will certainly destroy untimely death,
and will go to a place of blissful passing.

These things I shall now set forth.

Hear me, O divine Saṅgha.

Rejoice in this with delight,
and praise it, well held in mind.

Om. She of virtue, the greatly resplendent,
the great healer of the world, renowned,
Sarasvatī (goddess of speech) with wide eyes,
she who increases wisdom and splendor,
the healer and the one who causes flourishing,
Svāhā — she of the form of Om who is desirable in form,
devoted to benefiting all sentient beings,
the victorious woman who liberates from battle,
the goddess who is the Perfection of Wisdom,
the noble Tārā, the beautiful,
she who flourishes with drum and conch,
the queen of knowledge, of pleasant speech,
the great white one with a moon face,
wearing the unconquered robe of gold,
the great illusion-maker, the great white one,
perfected in going beyond the great and powerful,
the greatly fierce, the greatly terrible,

the destroyer of hostile sentient beings,
the utterly pacified, of peaceful form,
the completely victorious, of blazing light,
bearing a victory banner of lightning garlands,
bearing sword, wheel, bow, and weapons,
the searcher, the stirrer-up, the great black one,
the night-black one, she who moves by night,
the protectress, the bewilderer, the peaceful one,
the beautiful, the virtuous, the net-soarer,
the Brahmā-woman and the Vedic one,
the killer, she who dwells in mountain caves,
the auspicious, the one who accomplishes peace,
she of the birth-place of knowledge, swift of mind,
the skull-bearing one, of great force,
the Brahmā-woman, the blissful, unconquered by others,
the great caravan-leader, the abode of compassion,
she who excellently shows the path of destruction,
the bestower of the supreme, the teacher, the instructress,
she who surpasses immeasurable female forms,
the hermit woman and the yoginī,
the accomplished one, the fierce one, the ambrosia woman,
the nurturing mother, the wealth-giver, the meritorious one,
the greatly fortunate, the auspiciously fortunate, the beauty-displayer,
she who brings to an end, she who causes dread, the terrifying one,
the mother of fierce and great asceticism,
devoted to benefiting all beings as one,
the protectress, compassionate toward the reverent,
the sovereign of speech, the peacefully subtle one,
she who always follows all who go,
the good one who accomplishes all purposes,
the slayer, the healer, the wealth-bestower,
the fearless, the meritorious, Gautamī,
born of the very essence of Avalokiteśvara —

These one hundred and eight names
are renowned as ones that bring benefit.
They are supremely wondrous, secret,

difficult to find even in the realm of the gods.
They grant good fortune and auspicious destiny,
they diminish all poisons,
the peaceful one who pacifies all illness,
the one who bestows happiness on all sentient beings.

Whoever possesses wisdom and recites them three times,
having set themselves in meditative equipoise and cleanliness,
will before long attain
the splendor of royal dominion.

The continuously sorrowful will become happy.

The poor will become wealthy.

The bewildered will attain great wisdom.

That the mind will become stable, there is no doubt.

The bound will be freed from bondage.

One will be victorious even in litigation.

Enemies will become friends.

Those with horns and those with fangs,
hard to overcome in fierce and jealous combat,
and from various terrors and conflicts —
by remembering these names,
one is freed from all fears.

One is freed from untimely death,
and a person will attain renown.

One will be born as a human being with purpose.

By the benefit of this alone —
whoever rises up early here
and proclaims it,

that one will long possess life,
will rejoice in human splendor,
and gods, nāgas, yakṣas,
gandharvas, piśācas (flesh-eating spirits),
elementals, rākṣasas of violent power,

māmo spirits of fierce and wrathful mind,
yakṣiṇīs, and those who cause one to become a hungry ghost,
those who cause madness and those who bring harm,
those who cast shadows and those who cause forgetfulness,

flesh-eaters and the like,
various kinds of risen corpses and such,
rousing mothers and those of hateful mind —
even upon their shadows one will not tread.
How then could they come near to do worship?
Sentient beings of hateful mind they bind,
yet one will not be struck by disease and the like.
One will be wealthy, endowed with enjoyments and good qualities.
Sons and grandsons will increase.
One will be well-born and pleasing to behold.
Possessed of majesty and with speech that is clear,
one will be born with an intelligent mind, endowed with mindfulness.
One will come to know all treatises.
One will be truly endowed with a genuine spiritual friend.
Adorned perfectly with the awakening mind,
in whatever place and wherever one is born, always —

Translator's Notes

- The passage opens mid-sentence with a colophon fragment attributing the translation to the Indian paṇḍita Dharmashrimitra and the Tibetan translator-monk Chökyi Zangpo; it appears the text begins partway through the colophon of a preceding work, with the main text then starting afresh.

The term rendered "queens of wisdom-knowledge" translates rig pa'i rgyal mo, literally "queens of vidyā," referring to wisdom-deity queens, a class of tantric feminine deity.

The phrase rendered "age of weapons" translates mtshon cha'i bskal pa, literally "the aeon or time of weapons," a standard reference to an era of warfare and conflict among the cosmic deteriorations.

The passage near the end where Tārā herself speaks in the first person, including the words "I know her as mother of the world," involves a subtle shift in voice. The frame begins with Vajrapāṇi quoting Avalokiteśvara, who then quotes Tārā speaking of herself; the passage is somewhat compressed and the speaker attributions shift rapidly, which is characteristic of the genre.

- The passage contains a long series of epithets for Tārā, rendered as names in a liturgical list. Several of these are somewhat opaque or compound epithets that admit more than one interpretation; the renderings given follow the most natural syntactic reading and standard iconographic associations. The term "Gautamī" near the end of the list appears as a name-epithet of Tārā, alluding to her connection with the Gautama lineage or the Buddha; it is left as a proper name since it functions as such in context. The phrase "mdzad" after "phyag thabs" in the opening line could mean he "performed" or "made" the gesture; "performed" is adopted as most natural. The passage ends mid-sentence, as the source text provided is itself incomplete at that point.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the final word, which means "always" or "continuously," as it is a fragment leading into the next verse. The rendering follows accordingly.

The phrase rendered "those who cast shadows" refers to spirit-beings who afflict by overshadowing a person, a recognized category in the Indic demonological tradition underlying such texts.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.